



The birth of Hollywood

Hollywood was formed by a group of film makers wanting to get away from Edison and his patents! <http://bit.ly/qIykv7>

Massless speakers

Plasma speakers are a form of massless speakers where plasma drives the air around you to produce sound. <http://bit.ly/n7IhSf>

Nokia X7

Just great looks, nothing much

Specifications

Platform: Symbian Anna;
Processor: ARM 11 680MHz with Broadcom BCM2727 GPU; **RAM:** 256 MB; **Display:** 4.0 inches AMOLED capacitive touchscreen, 640x360 pixel resolution; **Memory:** microSD slot up to 32 GB; **Camera:** 8 MP with 720p HD video, dual LED flash; **Battery:** 1200 mAh

Contact

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Price: ₹22,829

6.0
10

Features.....6.0
 Performance.....6.5
 Build Quality.....7.0
 Value for Money.....5.5

If you have ₹20k to spend on a touchscreen smartphone, the choices are just endless. A gamut of solid Android phones- Samsung Galaxy S i9003, Samsung Google Nexus S and the LG Optimus Black, are available. Plus, let us not forget that the ageing Apple iPhone 3GS is now available for around ₹19k after the recent price reduction.

The Nokia X7 handset looks superb. It's edgy with the corners angling inwards giving it quite a futuristic look. The sides are also at an angle - curved inwards towards the rear panel. It seems like there are speakers hidden away on all four angled corners, but actually, there are only two - the other two are evidently for uniformity. The mixture of plastic and aluminium does give the phone a classy look.

Carrying forward from the trend set by the Nokia N8, the SIM card slot is on the left side,

and so is the microSD card slot. Push them in from one side, and once the other end emerges, pull it out! This mechanism isn't very smooth to operate. What we don't really understand is the point of such a design.

There really is no other way of putting this - the X7 isn't a performance phone at all. A 680MHz processor with 256MB of RAM is a bit of a disappointment. While some may argue that the Anna update has changed things, the reality is that this change has only happened up to a certain extent.

Moving beyond this disappointment, the 4-inch AMOLED display is quite good. Colours are appreciably distinct, but do lack a bit of punch in terms of vividness. The crispness is quite good, and shows in the clarity of the text - reading text on websites, for example is a pretty good experience. The brightness is quite

solid, so much so that turning it up too much may lead to the display becoming uncomfortable to use.

The updated web browser is one of the really good things to come out of the Anna update. Web pages render quicker and smoother. Pinch to zoom works in a smoother fashion and the text generally fits well. The good old feeling continues from the Nokia E6!

The X7 does tend to become a bit hot when browsing the web, or while chatting on the phone for a long time. And the metal back does induce some sweat on ones palms.

Battery backup is very good, and full marks to Nokia here. The X7 offers two full days of usage, more than what we bargained for.

Symbian Anna is like a completely new OS, in some respects. The Anna update has gone a long way in bringing it closer to Android. The performance has improved appreciably. However, Nokia's Social app needs a complete overhaul - poor design, literally no configurable features and no integration with the contacts.

The Nokia X7 is quite a unique looking phone, and kudos to Nokia for finally getting aesthetics right, at least for the most part. At 20,000 bucks, it lands slam bang in the hottest price bracket in the smartphone market - and therefore also has to contend with the most competition.

Unfortunately it doesn't stand out in its price segment. Symbian Anna gives the X7 an edge over the N8, (in terms of performance), which while part of a different series could be called a spiritual predecessor. It is strictly for those who find its looks appealing, or Symbian/Nokia aficionados.

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